



Capstone Faculty Mentor Briefing Template

Last updated: July 14, 2025

Instructions:

The purpose of this document is to summarize progress made over the previous term so the faculty mentor can get caught up quickly. Activities last term should have included at least 1-2 meetings with the sponsor to initiate relevant onboarding and training, discovery, obtaining access to data, and a brief data review. Things may change over the course of capstone, and this information can evolve. The information can also be carried forward to the Progress Reports submitted later.

This document is to be emailed to the faculty mentor in the first week of the capstone course. It will be graded according to the rubric below **in green font**.

TOTAL POINTS: 10

I. PROJECT BACKGROUND

[B1] (1 POINT) Stakeholder Names and Roles

In the table below, enter information for each team member, mentor, and sponsor. On the sponsor side, there may be several stakeholders including project manager, data contact, etc.

Stakeholder	Role
Name 1	Team member / mentor / sponsor role

[B2] Project Title: [enter title]

[B3] (1 POINT) Abstract

Enter abstract

II. DISCOVERY

[D1] (3 POINTS; full credit given if attempt was made AND details are provided below)

Did some subset of the student team meet with the sponsor? If so, briefly summarize the discussion.

You might include:

- *The business purpose of the project*
- *How your work will be used in practice. By working backwards from the goal, you will be more likely to solve the right problem.*
- *Why the project is important*
- *Who are the stakeholders*
- *Important assumptions*
- *What is in scope / out of scope (as needed)*
- *What are the success criteria*

If you did not meet with the sponsor, explain what prevented a meeting.

[D2] (3 POINTS; full credit given if attempt was made AND details are provided below)

Did you receive data? If so, briefly describe the data. If not, explain what prevented receipt of the data.

[D3] If you received the data, did you have a chance to review it? Did you notice any potential challenges with the data?

III. COMPUTING

[C1] (1 POINT) Given what you know about the data, what do you plan to use for data storage (e.g., Google Drive, Rivanna)?

[C2] (1 POINT) Given what you know about the data, what do you plan to use for computing (e.g., Google Colab, your local machine, Rivanna)?

IV. MISC

Anything else you would like to share with the faculty mentor?